THE LIFE OF JOSÉ RIZAL FROM CHILDHOOD TO COLLEGE

I. Introduction

Dr. José Rizal was born on June 19, 1861, in Calamba, Laguna. He is known as the national hero of the Philippines because of his writings and his efforts to help Filipinos during the Spanish colonial period. From a young age, Rizal was already interested in reading, writing, and learning new things. His family and education helped shape him into the person he became. This research discusses the important events in his life, from his childhood until his college years.



II. Childhood and Family Background (1861–1870)

José Rizal was born to Francisco Mercado and Teodora Alonso. He was the seventh of eleven children in their family. His parents taught their children the importance of education, good manners, and religion. His mother was his first teacher and taught him how to read, write, and pray. As a child, Rizal enjoyed reading stories, writing poems, and drawing. His interest in learning started at home and helped prepare him for school.



Source: National Commission for Culture and the Arts (NCCA)
https://ncca.gov.ph/about-culture-and-arts/in-focus/nation-observes-142nd-birth-anniversary-of-jose…

III. Early Education in Biñan (1870)

In 1870, Rizal went to Biñan, Laguna, to continue his studies. He studied under a teacher named Justiniano Aquino Cruz. During his time there, he learned different subjects and improved his reading and writing skills. He also experienced studying away from his family, which helped him become more independent. Rizal returned to Calamba later that year after completing this stage of his early education.





Source: JoséRizal.com, Rizal's Childhood and Early Education
[Jose Rizal Childhood and Early Education: Calamba, Biñan and the Moth]

IV. Education at Ateneo Municipal de Manila (1872–1877)

In 1872, Rizal entered Ateneo Municipal de Manila, where he studied under Jesuit priests. He worked hard in his classes and became one of the outstanding students. He studied subjects such as languages, mathematics, and literature. He also continued developing his talents in poetry and drawing. On March 23, 1877, he graduated with a Bachelor of Arts degree and excellent academic standing. His achievements showed his dedication to studying and improving his knowledge.



Source: Wikimedia Commons, José Rizal historical portraits
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/Jos%C3%A9_Rizal

V. College Education at the University of Santo Tomas (1877–1882)

After graduating from Ateneo, Rizal continued his studies at the University of Santo Tomas in 1877. He first studied Philosophy and Letters before pursuing medicine. He wanted to become a doctor and help people, especially his mother, who had an eye problem. During this period, he also studied surveying at Ateneo. While studying in Manila, he became more aware of the unfair treatment of Filipinos under Spanish rule. These experiences helped him understand the problems faced by his fellow countrymen. In May 1882, he left the Philippines for Spain to continue his education.



Source: JoséRizal.com, José Rizal Biography
[Jose Rizal Biography: Life, Works, Exile, and Death of the National Hero]